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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED MEETS ORGANISING TEAM OF 54TH EID AL ETIHAD

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received the organising team of the UAE's 54th Eid Al Etihad. During the meeting, Sheikh Mohamed greeted members of the organising team and expressed his appreciation for their tireless efforts in successfully organising the celebrations.

President, UK PM discuss bilateral ties

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Andy Burnham, Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, discussed bilateral relations and ways to enhance ties across various fields in a phone call.

During the call, Sheikh Mohamed congratulated Burnham on his appointment, wishing him success in leading his country towards further progress and prosperity.

Both sides expressed their aspirations to work together to deepen enduring UAE-UK relations and expand cooperation. Sheikh Mohamed and Burnham also exchanged views on a number of issues of common interest. — WAM

DXB tops global rankings as world's busiest airport hub

International seat capacity jumps 18%, cementing Dubai's aviation lead

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai International Airport has topped global rankings for scheduled international seat capacity in July 2026, reinforcing its position at the centre of long-haul travel demand as traffic continues to recover across key corridors.

Data published by the UK-based aviation analytics firm OAG shows the airport offering 4.35 million international seats during the month, placing it ahead of Heathrow Airport, Amsterdam Airport Schiphol, Incheon International Airport and Charles de Gaulle Airport.

Heathrow ranked second with 4.23 million seats, down 1

per cent, followed by Schiphol with 3.82 million seats, up 1 per cent. Incheon recorded 3.75 million seats, while Charles de Gaulle reached 3.70 million, both broadly in line with last year's levels, according to 24.ae news portal.

Sustained expansion

Dubai's capacity rose 18 per cent year on year, underlining a sustained expansion in international connectivity.

The airport had already led global rankings earlier in 2026, surpassing Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta International Airport in January with 5.5 million scheduled seats, and maintaining its lead in February with 4.9 million, according to OAG's monthly data.

Dubai retained its position in 2025 as the world's busiest airport for international passenger traffic by seat capacity, with 62.4 million seats, a 4 per cent increase on 2024.

NATION

Dubai commute to go from 20 to 5 minutes as RTA tackles bottlenecks | P 2

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TRUCE TALKS PUSH FORWARD AS US PAUSES AIRSTRIKES

Iran and Oman hold several rounds of technical talks

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The US military has paused its airstrikes on Iran after nearly two weeks of intensifying bombing, while diplomatic efforts have pushed forward to try to avert a return to all-out war.

A regional official involved in the mediation efforts said that concerted diplomacy was under way and that a pause in US strikes and Iranian counter-strikes on neighbouring countries hosting American forces was a "positive signal that helps their efforts to de-escalate."

The official said that both the US and Iran want to return to the interim ceasefire deal and that a compromise, which is being negotiated now, centres around having Iran-run vessels transit through the Strait of Hormuz with fewer restrictions on ships. The official was not authorised to discuss the matter and spoke to the Associated Press on condition of anonymity.

Making progress

Yesterday, Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesperson, Esmail Baghaei, confirmed that Iran and Oman had held several rounds of technical talks about the strait in Iran over the weekend.

He said that while the Omani delegation left Tehran on Saturday afternoon, talks had made progress and were continuing.

But it remains to be seen whether the US and Iran are at an inflection point in a mercurial conflict that will reach the five-month point tomorrow. President Donald Trump has threatened more strikes and said talks are pressing on, all while brushing off concerns that rising gas prices tied to the fighting could hurt Republicans in November's midterm elections.

Netanyahu's visit

Adding to the uncertainty is the impact of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's planned meeting with Trump next week in Washington. Israel, which launched the war alongside the US on Feb. 28, has been notably absent from the renewed American attacks over Iran's effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Despite the lull in fighting, tensions are high in the region.

Yemen's Houthi rebels said Saturday that they fired missiles and drones at Saudi Arabia in response to Saudi airstrikes on the strategic Red Sea city of Hodeida. The Iran-backed rebels say they have closed the Bab Al Mandeb Strait.

SEE ALSO P 5, 6

Wadi Wurayah is the UAE's first Unesco-listed natural heritage site

Inscription recognises site's exceptional natural significance

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Wadi Wurayah National Park in Fujairah has been inscribed on Unesco's World Heritage List, becoming the first site in the UAE to be recognised for its Outstanding Universal Natural Value and the country's third World Heritage property.

The decision was announced during the 48th session of Unesco's World Heritage Committee in Busan, South Korea, following



the committee's review of the UAE's nomination dossier.

The inscription recognises Wadi Wurayah's exceptional natural significance, including its rich biodiversity, unique geological formations and role as one of the Arabian Peninsula's most important freshwater ecosystems.

The designation marks a milestone in the UAE's environmental conservation efforts and reflects the country's long-term commitment to protecting its natural heritage in line with international standards.

SPORT

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